

Python Programming

CSC-121

Fall 2026 Section 0002 3 Credit(s) 08/17/2026 to 12/16/2026 Delivery Method: Online
Modified 08/16/2026

How & When our Course Meets

Course Format:

Synchronous Online: Fully online course with required virtual meetings at scheduled dates and times; College curriculum or continuing education course in which 100% of the instruction is delivered online. Students who do not complete the Course Entry Quiz by the 10% mark of class noted on the course calendar will be removed from class and marked as "Never Attended."

Schedule Adjustment and Withdrawals

Each semester, you have a window of opportunity to make changes to your course schedule or withdraw. The timing of when you withdraw impacts how much, if any, of your tuition may be refunded and may also impact your financial aid.

To view the withdrawal deadlines, please visit [Wake Tech's Calendar](https://www.waketech.edu/student-services/registration-student-records) (<https://www.waketech.edu/student-services/registration-student-records>).

To view the comprehensive withdrawal policy, visit [Withdrawal Policy](https://www.waketech.edu/catalog/academic-information) (<https://www.waketech.edu/catalog/academic-information>).

To contact financial aid, visit [Financial Aid](https://www.waketech.edu/%EF%AC%81nancial-aid) (<https://www.waketech.edu/%EF%AC%81nancial-aid>).

Meet Your Instructor

Instructor: Cindy Halliday

Email: clhalliday@waketech.edu

Office: Teams

Office Hours

Tuesday, 12:00 PM to 3:00 PM, Teams

What This Course Is About

This course introduces computer programming using the Python programming language. Emphasis is placed on common algorithms and programming principles utilizing the standard library distributed with Python. Upon completion, students should be able to design, code, test, and debug Python language programs.

Credits:3

Requisites

Prerequisite (must be completed before taking the course): CTI-110 or CSC-120

What You'll Learn: Student Learning Outcomes

Program Level Outcomes

Upon completion of this program:

1. Software Development students will demonstrate competent programming skills in at least two programming languages.
2. Software Development students will write programs, manage data, develop applications, consider user interfaces/experiences, and utilize cloud technologies.
3. Software Development students will work effectively as a member of a team to solve real-world problems.
4. Software Development students will demonstrate quality and security of all written code and data.

Student Learning Outcomes

Upon completion of this course, students will be able to:

- Design an algorithmic solution to solve a problem
- Understand fundamental Python language constructs that support data storage, computation, control structures as well as the built-in functions and methods.
- Compose functions and integrate them in a program
- Understand principles of object-oriented programming
- Use class and other object-oriented programming techniques in a program

What You'll Need: Textbook & Materials

Eagle Advantage is Wake Tech's textbook program for students in degree programs, excluding Career & College Promise (CCP) and Cooperative Innovative High School (Early College) students. The program ensures all required printed and digital textbooks are bundled and ready for pickup or delivery on or before the first day of class - saving you time and money and ensuring you're ready to learn on Day One.

If you are opted-in to Eagle Advantage, visit the 'Course Materials-BibliU' link in Blackboard for more information about the textbook details for your course. You can also find out more information by visiting [FAQs and Troubleshooting – BibliU \(https://support.bibliu.com/hc/en-us/sections/360004011038--FAQs-and-Troubleshootin\)](https://support.bibliu.com/hc/en-us/sections/360004011038--FAQs-and-Troubleshootin).

If you opted-out of Eagle Advantage, you are responsible for purchasing any of the required texts/materials for this course. For more information about Eagle Advantage, contact our [Bookstore \(https://www.waketechcampusstore.com/SelectTermDept\)](https://www.waketechcampusstore.com/SelectTermDept).

Starting Out With Python

Author: Tony Gaddis

Publisher: Pearson

Edition: 6th Edition

ISBN: 978-0137619139

Supplies and Software

It is important that you have access to a computer with reliable Internet access to complete assignments. Also, please check your Wake Tech email and Blackboard frequently for any important updates. This computer's Operating System must be either Window 10 or higher or Mac OS 10.13 (High Sierra) or higher.

You will need to install the latest versions of **Python** and **PyCharm** on your computer. You will use this free software to write and run Python programs. Instructions for download and installation of this software will be provided by your instructor.

Additionally, this course will use proctoring software to ensure the academic integrity of the Midterm exam. In this course section we will be using Respondus for on-line proctoring. A working web camera and microphone are required to use this software. Details for using and installing the proctoring software will be provided by your instructor via Blackboard prior to the Midterm.

✓ How Your Work will be Evaluated: Grading Information

Criteria

Grading Scale

This course uses a 10-point grading scale. The final weighted numeric grade average is rounded to the nearest whole number to compute the course letter grade.

Course Grade	Criteria	Notes
A	90% and above	
B	80-89%	
C	70-79%	
D	60-69%	

F	Less than 60%		
Type	Weight	Topic	Notes
Lab Assignments	30%		Generally, these assignments will be Python programs that you either create from scratch or by using starter templates that are provided in the assignment. They will be submitted weekly.
Quizzes	20%		These open book tests will be submitted weekly as attendance assignments.
Supplemental Activities	10%		There will be additional assignments given to help you learn the material.
Midterm Exam	20%		This exam is a comprehensive exam covering the first half of the course.
Final Exam	20%		The Final Exam will be the PCEP Certification Exam. Taking this exam will give you the opportunity to earn a professional credential at the end of the course.

How You'll Proceed Through the Course: Course Calendar

Please follow the course schedule below.

In case you do not make the submission deadline, you still have a chance to complete the lab assignment for credit if you submit within 2 days of the deadline, however assignments submitted in those two days will be graded with a 20% penalty. No student may submit lab assignments more than two days past the deadline and the assignments will close in Blackboard.

Quizzes and supplemental activities will not be accepted after the due date.

Exams must be taken on the assigned date; otherwise, a grade of zero will be assigned. Any exception to this policy must be the result of a documented emergency or prior arrangement with the instructor. There will be no exceptions to this rule.

ANY MAKEUP EXAMS must be taken prior to the scheduled exam date. This must be pre-arranged with the instructor. Last minute arrangements are not acceptable.

When	Topic	Notes
Lesson 1 8/17/2026 - 8/23/2026 Online, Teams	Getting Started Input, Processing, Output	Course Entry Assessments Weekly Assignments. Due date: 8/23/2026

When	Topic	Notes
Lesson 2 8/24/2026 - 8/30/2026 Online, Teams	Decision Structures and Boolean Logic	Weekly Assignments. Due date: 8/30/2026
Lesson 3 8/31/2026 - 9/6/2026 Online, Teams	Repetition Structures	Weekly Assignments. Due date: 9/6/2026
Lesson 4 9/7/2026 - 9/13/2026 Online, Teams	Functions Part 1	Weekly Assignments. Due date: 9/13/2026
Lesson 5 9/14/2026 - 9/20/2026 Online, Teams	Functions Part 2, Lists and Tuples Part 1	Weekly Assignments. Due date: 9/20/2026
Lesson 6 9/21/2026 - 9/27/2026 Online, Teams	Lists and Tuples Part 2	Weekly Assignments. Due date: 9/27/2026
Lesson 7 9/28/2026 - 10/4/2026 Online, Teams	More About Strings	Weekly Assignments. Due date: 10/4/2026
Midterm Exam 10/5/2026 - 10/11/2026 Online	Midterm Exam (Covers Lesson 1 to Lesson 7)	Due date: 10/11/2026
Lesson 8 10/12/2026 - 10/18/2026 Online, Teams	Files and Exceptions	Weekly Assignments. Due date: 10/18/2026
Lesson 9 10/19/2026 - 10/25/2026 Online, Teams	Dictionaries and Sets	Weekly Assignments. Due date: 10/25/2026
Lesson 10 10/26/2026 - 11/1/2026 Online, Teams	More about Dictionaries	Weekly Assignments. Due date: 11/1/2026
Lesson 11 11/2/2026 - 11/8/2026 Online, Teams	Classes and OO Programming	Weekly Assignments. Due date: 11/8/2026

When	Topic	Notes
Lesson 12 11/9/2026 - 11/15/2026 Online, Teams	OO Programming Part 2	Weekly Assignments. Due date: 11/15/2026
Lesson 13 11/16/2026 - 11/22/2026 Online, Teams	Recursion	Weekly Assignments. Due date:11/22/2026
Lesson 4 11/30/2026 - 12/6/2026 Online, Teams	Certification Exam Prep	PCEP Practice Test. Due date: 12/6/2026
PCEP Certification Exam 12/7/2026 - 12/13/2026 Online	PCEP Certification Exam	Due date: 12/13/2026

* How I Will Help You Succeed: Instructor Policies & Procedures

Communication Expectations

The primary means for contacting me is through our Wake Tech email. When emailing, please be sure to include your course and section number. You can also communicate with me in-person during office/student hours. Please use your provided my.waketech.edu e-mail account for all school-related correspondence. Due to security concerns, any emails from a personal account may not be delivered successfully.

During the week, I will reply to emails within 24 hours. If I do not respond within 24 hours, please contact me again to follow up. On the weekends, my responses may be delayed.

Attendance

Attendance is key for your courses here at Wake Tech! We expect you to be in attendance for at least 90 percent of all scheduled class meetings. If you miss more than 10% of scheduled classes/activities, you may be withdrawn from the course. Additionally, if you are not present for 2 consecutive weeks of class, you will be withdrawn by the instructor.

Attendance for this class will be evaluated through attendance in our online Teams meetings. If you are not present in the first 30 minutes of our online meeting or if you miss more than 30 minutes of the class, you will be counted as absent for the class. If you are 10 minutes late to the course or miss 10-30 minutes of class, you will be counted as tardy which will be considered a ½ absence.

Plagiarism and Professionalism

This department has a zero-tolerance policy on plagiarism. All coursework should be your own. Any work which has been plagiarized or is discovered to be plagiarized will be hurtful to your reputation, the school, the program, and the faculty and students within it.

Please do not do any of the following in your coursework:

- Use Artificial Intelligence (AI) Tools to complete your assignment (unless directed by your instructor).
- Create a copy of someone else's work either in part or whole.
- Copy code from online sources and submit it as your own.
- Concepts and portions of other works may be used if they comprise a minor part of a submitted assignment. Those works must be cited and include a URL for the source used.
- Use prebuilt templates without your instructor's permission
- Use stock images that are not licensed as free for commercial use with no attribution. All images used should be cited in the assignment submission box.
- Use someone else's work or ideas. Inspiration turns into imitation when copying what is considered the crux—or central idea—of the work.

Anyone submitting plagiarized work or violating the college's academic integrity policy will be reported to a Student Conduct Officer and will (at minimum) receive a zero for the assignment.

Penalties for Academic Integrity Violations

- **1st offense:** 0 on assignment with an FYI letter from the Student Conduct Office with the recommendation to complete the Plagiarism in a Digital World session offered by the TLC
- **2nd offense:** WD from course with the grade of F
- **2nd offense in the same semester 2 different classes:** WD from 2nd course with the grade of F
- **2nd offense in 2 different semesters same classes:** WD from course with the grade of F
- **2nd offense in 2 different semesters 2 different classes:** WD from 2nd course with the grade of F

When taking exams or quizzes, students will not give or receive aid. This includes discussing the exam or providing copies of the quiz with or to students who have not yet taken it. Course material, including exams/quizzes, must not be posted online without the college's approval. If you are aware of cheating on any assessment, students have an obligation to inform the instructor.

Code Reviews

During the semester, instructors may request that students attend code review meetings to explain their submitted assignments and demonstrate their understanding of the concepts used. Code reviews may be requested if the submitted work includes advanced topics not yet covered in the course, shows a significant deviation in coding style, exhibits patterns suggesting external assistance, or indicates the use of unauthorized resources.

Use of Artificial Intelligence (AI) Tools

The use of Artificial Intelligence (AI) tools, such as code-generation AI, predictive coding software, or other automated programming assistance tools, is not permitted unless explicitly specified in the assignment instructions.

This policy aims to ensure that students develop a deep understanding of Python programming concepts and hone their problem-solving skills. Violations of this policy may be considered breaches of academic integrity, leading to consequences as outlined under Plagiarism and Professionalism.

If you have any questions or uncertainties about the use of a particular tool or resource, please reach out to your instructor for clarification. Remember, learning programming is not just about reaching the correct answer, but about understanding the process and developing critical thinking skills.

How the Department Will Help You Succeed: Department Policies & Procedures

Tutoring and Learning Center

The Tutoring and Learning Center (TLC) offers Wake Tech students free tutoring and learning support for their classes. The mission of the TLC is to help students understand what they are learning in class, develop the skills they need to be successful in college and the workplace, and empower them to be independent learners.

Visit the TLC at [Tutoring and Learning Center Site](https://www.waketech.edu/student-services/tutoring-learning-center) (<https://www.waketech.edu/student-services/tutoring-learning-center>)

Information & Digital Technology Care Team

The IT Care Team provides specialized advising and coaching support for University Transfer students interested in IT and Associate in Applied Science students enrolled in Information Technology programs.

Visit the IT Care Team website at [IT Care Team Site](https://www.waketech.edu/student-services/advising/information-technology) (<https://www.waketech.edu/student-services/advising/information-technology>)

How the Division Will Help You Succeed: Division Policies & Procedures

Process for Expressing Concerns about the Course

1. Please discuss concerns with your instructor first.
2. If your concerns are not resolved, you may contact the Department Head or Program Director of the department.

General Division Questions

For general questions regarding the Information Technology Division or assistance with program resources, students may contact Associate Dean Emmie Mercer at ermercer1@waketech.edu for guidance or referral to the appropriate department.

Information Technology Technical Standards

This page outlines the technical standards and essential skills expected of students in Information Technology programs. Review this page for descriptions of the critical-thinking, communication, interpersonal, behavioral, and technical abilities needed to complete coursework and perform effectively in professional IT environments: [IT Technical Standards \(https://www.waketech.edu/about-waketech/divisions/information-technology/technical-standards\)](https://www.waketech.edu/about-waketech/divisions/information-technology/technical-standards).



How the College Will Help You Succeed: Wake Tech Services, Policies and Procedures

Wake Tech is committed to supporting you by providing the resources needed to succeed. This is a brief overview of support available at the College. You can always contact me to help you make the right connection with a college resource. We are here to help!

Student Support

As a Wake Tech student, you have free access to non-academic and academic resources to help you with a range of challenges. These resources include academic services, such as advising, tutoring and academic coaching to help you understand your career and academic pathway, Disability Support Services, Tutoring and Learning Centers, Career Services, and Library Services. The college also offers assistance with basic life needs through the Care Center. These services include mental health resources, emergency financial assistance, safe housing, transportation, and technology. If you find yourself in need, you can reach out to any faculty member or visit this website [Student Support \(https://www.waketech.edu/studentsupport\)](https://www.waketech.edu/studentsupport) to learn more about the help that we can provide.

Student Activities

Wake Tech is continually developing new ways for you to get involved with the College! For information about the Student Centers, Student Government Association, Clubs and Organizations, Athletics, and more, please visit the [College Catalog \(https://www.waketech.edu/catalog/student-services-and-activities\)](https://www.waketech.edu/catalog/student-services-and-activities).

Technical Support

Wake Tech has several technology platforms to help you succeed. You may find that technical questions come up regarding your use of technology and Wake Tech is here to help. For technical support, including Blackboard, WTCC email, MS Teams, and Self Service visit the [IT Helpdesk page \(https://www.waketech.edu/help-center/its/topics\)](https://www.waketech.edu/help-center/its/topics).

Student Code of Conduct, Rights, and Responsibilities

You may have questions about your rights and responsibilities as a student. Wake Tech has a range of policies to address such concerns. For information about the Academic Integrity Policy, Complaints, Title IX Policy, Student Appeals, and more, please visit the [College Catalog \(https://www.waketech.edu/catalog/student-code-conduct-rights-and-responsibilities\)](https://www.waketech.edu/catalog/student-code-conduct-rights-and-responsibilities).

Academic Policies

There are several Wake Tech policies related to academics that you might need to reference in order to succeed in your classes. If you have questions about the Attendance Policy, Student Email Policy, Absences for Religious Observances, Withdrawal Policies, Grades, and more, please visit the [College Catalog \(https://www.waketech.edu/catalog/academic-information\)](https://www.waketech.edu/catalog/academic-information).

Student Information Privacy

Wake Tech is committed to protecting your privacy. The Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA) is a federal law enacted in 1974 that protects the privacy of student education records. To find out more about College policies and procedures that support your privacy, please visit the [College Catalog \(https://www.waketech.edu/catalog/registration-and-student-records\)](https://www.waketech.edu/catalog/registration-and-student-records).

Campus Policies

There are several Wake Tech policies related to campus procedures that you might need to reference to feel comfortable on campus. For information about College Police and Safety, the Acceptable Use of College Resources Policy, (Student Dress, Pets, Visitors and Children on Campus, and more, please visit the [College Catalog \(https://www.waketech.edu/catalog/campus-policies-and-procedures\)](https://www.waketech.edu/catalog/campus-policies-and-procedures).

Registration & Student Records

For information about the Class Schedules, Registration Dates, Transcript Requests, Transfer Credits, Program of Study Changes, and more, please visit the [College Catalog \(https://www.waketech.edu/catalog/registration-and-student-records\)](https://www.waketech.edu/catalog/registration-and-student-records).

Financial Aid

Wake Tech is here to answer your financial aid questions. For information about Enrollment Requirements, Grants, Loans, Scholarships, and more, please visit the [College Catalog \(https://www.waketech.edu/catalog/financial-aid\)](https://www.waketech.edu/catalog/financial-aid).

Inclement Weather/Wake Tech WARN

North Carolina can have some unpredictable weather. For up-to-date information about Emergency Closings, please sign up for the College alert system, [Wake Tech WARN \(https://www.waketech.edu/about-wake-tech/administrative-offices/campus-police/waketech-warn\)](https://www.waketech.edu/about-wake-tech/administrative-offices/campus-police/waketech-warn). For more information about the inclement weather policy, please visit the [College Catalog \(https://www.waketech.edu/catalog/campus-policies-and-procedures\)](https://www.waketech.edu/catalog/campus-policies-and-procedures).

Additional Items
